

Senior Academy - IT training center

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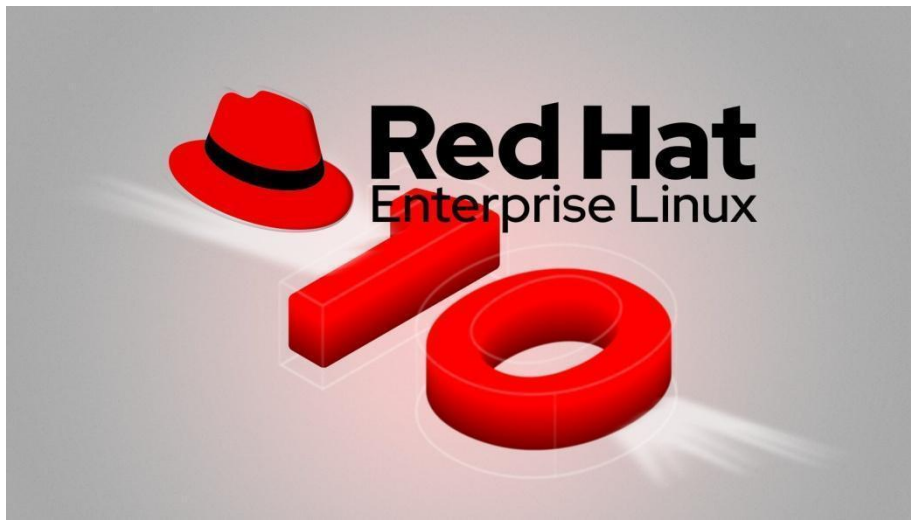
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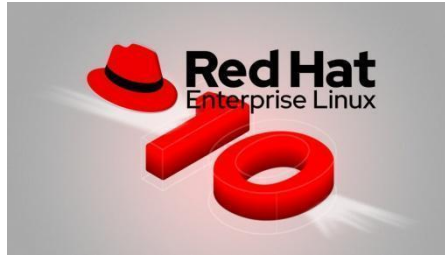
Linux System Administration Diploma



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Linux System Administration Diploma



Lab04

Managing Users and Groups

- **Group Management:** Create, rename, and modify GIDs.
- **User Provisioning:** Set custom UIDs, Shells, and Primary groups.
- **Account Modification:** Update GECOS, login names, and secondary memberships.
- **Membership Control:** Add/Remove users from specific groups.
- **System Verification:** Validate changes via `/etc/passwd` and `/etc/group`.

Lab Objectives

This lab covers fundamental Linux user and group administration. Students will practice creating and modifying system accounts by applying specific attributes like UIDs and login shells. The focus is on mastering group membership management and verifying system configurations by directly inspecting `/etc/passwd` and `/etc/group` files to ensure accuracy and security.

Phase 1: Group Infrastructure

1. **Create Group:** Create a group named `devops_interns` with a Group ID (GID) of 4000.
2. **Create Group:** Create a group named `temporary_admins`.
3. **Modify Group:** Rename the group `temporary_admins` to `sysadmins` and set its GID to 5000.
4. **Verification:** Verify the changes by inspecting the last 5 lines of `/etc/group`.

Phase 2: User Provisioning & Customization

1. **Create User:** Create user `sysadmin1` with a User ID (UID) of 2001 and set the login shell to `/bin/sh`.
2. **Create User:** Create user `sysadmin2` with a UID of 2002 and set their **primary group** to `sysadmins`.
3. **Create User & Password:** Create user `sysadmin3` with default settings and set a password for the account.
4. **Verification:** Verify the user attributes (UID, GID, and Shell) by inspecting `/etc/passwd`.

Phase 3: Account Modification & Membership

1. **Modify User Attributes:** For user `sysadmin1`, change the GECOS (comment) to "Senior System Admin" and change the login name to `lead_admin`.
2. **Add Secondary Group:** Add `sysadmin2` to `devops_interns` as a **secondary group**.
3. **Assign Primary Group:** Assign `sysadmin3` to the `sysadmins` group using the `-G` option (Note the effect on existing secondary memberships).
4. **Remove Secondary Group:** Remove `sysadmin2` from the `devops_interns` group without deleting the user or the group.

Phase 4: Verification & Cleanup

1. **User ID Verification:** Use the `id` command for all three users and compare the output with the records in `/etc/passwd` and `/etc/group`.
2. **Group Membership Check:** Check the `/etc/group` file to see which users are explicitly listed as members of `sysadmins`.
3. **Cleanup:** Delete `sysadmin3` along with its home directory.
4. **Final Verification:** Verify that `sysadmin3` no longer exists in `/etc/passwd`.

You are Welcome